

Roots Africa: Social Media & Informational Storytelling

Amanda Tuman, Anya Dhuria, Christina
Cosentino, Abd Allah Salem, Sumiyah Yusuf





Team Roles

01

Sumiyah - Project Manager

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Christina - Research Lead

03

Abdallah - Review and Editing

04

Anya - Client Communication Lead

05

Amanda - Format and Design



Client

- **ROOTS Africa**, founded by Cedric Nwafor, works to end hunger and poverty in Africa by promoting resilient agriculture through mentorship and youth engagement.
- Core Focus - their **Changemakers Program** connects university students and global mentors with African farmers to build sustainable, community-driven agricultural solutions.
- UMD Involvement - ROOTS Africa engages students in agriculture, international development, and communication efforts to further their mission and increase impact.





Capstone Objectives

- Enhance ROOTS Africa's presence on LinkedIn, Instagram, Facebook, and Substack to engage a **broader 35+ demographic**.
- Develop a long-term, **sustainable** social media strategy aligned with ROOTS Africa's mission and values.
- Create visual content, **engagement tools**, and performance tracking methods to increase outreach, donor engagement, and community visibility.





Requirements ROOTS Africa UMD

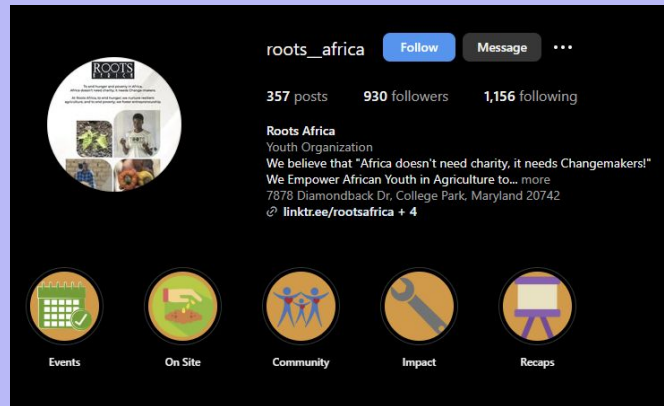
- Develop a **social media strategy** that expands ROOTS Africa's reach beyond college students to include 35+ year-olds and potential donors.
- Content must be visually appealing, mission-aligned, and accessible across LinkedIn, Instagram, Facebook, and Substack.
 - Must resonate with both younger audiences and older, more resource-capable supporters.
- Strategy must be sustainable given current constraints:
 - No dedicated social media staff or external funding for marketing professionals.
 - Limited time and technical resources among the current team to manage complex tools or long-term campaigns.





Deliverables

- A **long-term** social media strategy tailored to expand ROOTS Africa's audience and engagement across LinkedIn, Instagram, Facebook, and Substack.
- Structured content calendar and platform-specific recommendations:
 - Messaging guidelines and branding alignment.
 - Content types and posting frequency.
 - Tools/applications/software for scheduling, design, and analytics.
 - Estimation of staffing/time needed to implement the strategy.
 - Recommendations for sustainable management within budget constraints.
- User-friendly performance tracking template (Google Analytics, platform insights).

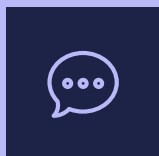


Progress



Completed

- Established project roles.
- Setup client communication through WhatsApp.
- Conducted research pertaining to the client's background and goals.
- Held an initial interview to establish guidelines and needs for the project- which have been finalized.
- Received approval on requirements from the client.



In-Progress

- Reviewing and gaining access to social media platforms to develop a social media strategy and extract data.
- Scheduling a meeting with the client about clarifications and to review the finalized plan.





Project Status

We are on schedule!

Our next interview is currently being scheduled, and we are in discussions about establishing our presence on their social media platforms and developing a strategy.



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Challenges



Communication

Communication between the client and the project team is often delayed due to differing schedules and responses at various times of the day.



Data Review

We are waiting to get authorized to manage their social platforms so we can begin data review and compiling a research document.

Goals

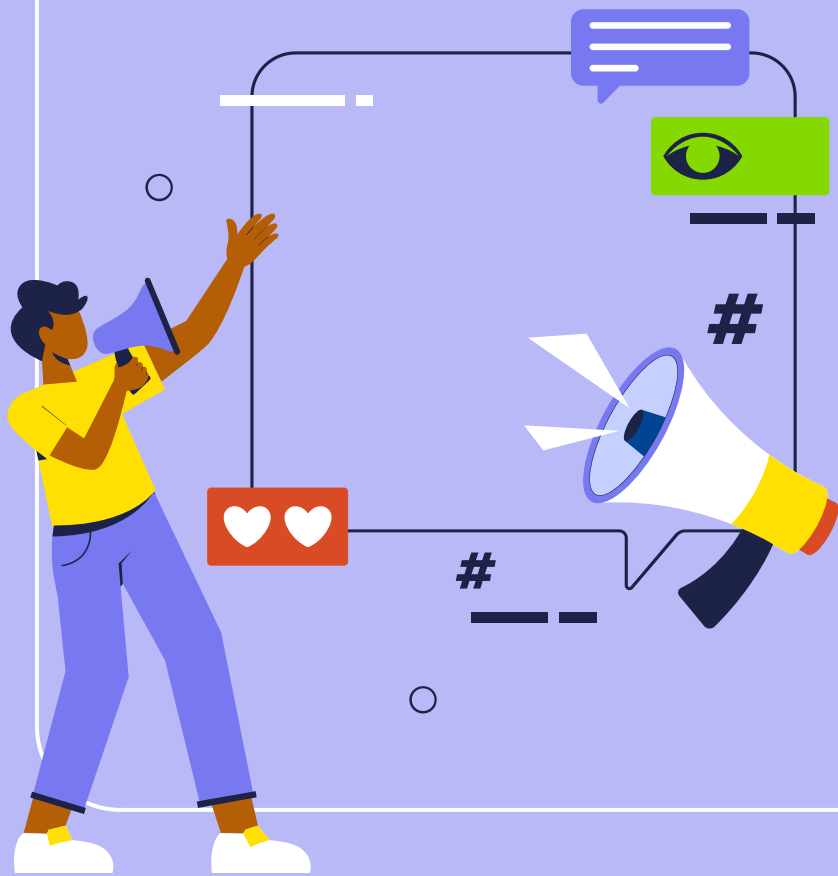
Strategy Development

- Review engagement metrics (likes, shares, comments, reach) across all platforms
- Identify which posts resonate most with the audience (e.g., visuals, themes, tone)
- Integrate personal stories of changemakers into regular content

Final Product

- Story-Driven: Prioritizes authentic voices and impact narratives
- Analytics-Informed: Built using top-performing post data and engagement trends
- Scalable: Designed for easy integration into ROOTS Africa's existing workflows





Thanks!

Does anyone have any questions?

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